

In This Month's

EFY
CDFocus on Free Software
for Circuit Design and
Web Development

TOP 5 SOFTWARE



KiCad. KiCad is an open-source solution for electronic design automation (EDA). Using it you can design schematics of electronics circuits and printed circuit boards. The software is developed by KiCad Jean-Pierre Charras. It also supports multiple languages such as English, Portuguese, Spanish, Czech, Polish, French, German and Russian.

Arduino. Arduino is an open-source electronics prototyping platform based on flexible, easy-to-use hardware and software. Its target audience is artists, designers, hobbyists, and anyone interested in creating interactive objects or environments. Arduino can sense the environment by receiving inputs from a variety of sensors and can affect its surroundings by controlling lights, motors and other actuators.

Tiny CAD. Using this open-source software, you can draw electronic circuit diagrams. It comes with complete libraries and let's you print the circuits that you have drawn. You can use TinyCAD to publish your drawings by copying and pasting into a Word document or saving as a PNG bitmap for the Web. You can also use it as a front

end to a number of PCB layout programs, by getting TinyCAD to create a netlist of your circuit.

Uniform Server. The Uniform Server is a WAMP (Windows, Apache, MySQL, PHP/Pearl) package that allows you to run a Web server on any MS Windows-based computer. It is a complete solution stack that helps you to develop and test an interactive website or Web-based application.

WampServer. This Windows Web development environment allows you to create Web applications with Apache, PHP and MySQL database. It also comes with PHPMyAdmin and SQLiteManager to easily manage your databases. WampServer installs automatically, and its usage is very intuitive. You will be able to tune your server without even touching the setting files.

EasyPHP. EasyPHP is a WAMP software bundle that installs Web server services onto the Windows computer and allows quick-and-easy development of PHP with MySQL on a local host (also known as 127.0.0.1). The package includes an Apache server, a MySQL database and the PHP extension.